

RHYTHMIC GROUPINGS (THREE 8THS, PART 1)

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #52

Rhythm is one of the most important, coolest elements of music, yet it so often ends up being a byproduct of everything else we are doing (melody, harmony, shape, range, etc.). Great music isn't all about which note to play, what scale to use, and employing the hippest harmonic device at every moment. Rhythm is what MANY people in the audience understand and are attracted to. Let's learn a bit more about that language!

We are beginning here (there will be much more to come) with the idea of grouping three 8th notes in 4/4 time. Simply thinking of groups of three 8ths notes. This is a big deal in 4/4 time, because in 4/4, the underlying grouping of the 8th notes is usually duple (meaning "based on twos"). In 4/4 time, we think of one quarter note as being built of two 8th notes. Four quarter notes = four groups of two 8th notes. Lots of twos!

When we begin thinking about groups of three 8ths in 4/4 time, we notice that those groups of threes 8ths don't fit evenly into a measure of eight 8ths. There are too many or too few 8th notes. There is a "remainder." They don't fit seamlessly. And you know what? That is AWESOME! That is where we begin to "play over the barlines," and where we begin finding some rhythmic richness and sophistication.

